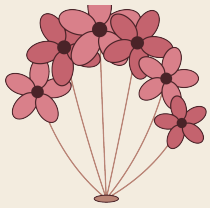
Petal Ping

Product Brief · Sprint 1 Update · AI Builder Space Proseminar

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Petal Ping is an integration tool that pulls real menstrual cycle and symptom data from a health app to deliver tailored, research-backed notifications and trend insights — built solo as a free, personalized alternative to tracking tools that are either too limited or too costly.

SECTION 1

Basics

Project: Petal Ping | **Creator:** Elle Brauchle (solo project) | **Type:** integration tool

Status: real data is flowing end to end and a push notification has been delivered to the phone; the daily scheduled send is the last piece.

SECTION 2

The Idea & The User

Petal Ping connects to an existing health app to track menstrual cycles and symptoms, and delivers tailored push notifications — heads-up reminders for upcoming cycles or symptoms, research-backed health tips, and alerts when trends emerge. A companion app displays this information, with an export option for medical appointments. It begins as a personal tool for Elle, with potential to expand to anyone managing periods — especially those with challenging or irregular cycles, or anyone interested in long-term trends — and eventually to other health-tracking needs. This is a “better version” opportunity: Apple Health offers only basic prediction with limited symptom logging, while more robust options like Flo are typically paid. Petal Ping combines tracking, tailored insights and trend alerts in one free, personalized tool.

SECTION 3

Existing Options

Similar tools exist, including Apple Health’s native cycle tracking and paid apps like Flo and Natural Cycles. Petal Ping is still being built from scratch on purpose: to learn to build software, because the tool directly benefits its creator, and to avoid a recurring subscription. This sprint confirmed the practical limit behind that choice — no consumer cycle app offers an individually accessible API, so some manual step at the data boundary is unavoidable. **Clue’s “export my data” function is now the data source**, chosen over Apple Health (HealthKit requires an on-device app and a certificate that expires weekly) and over Flo and Natural Cycles (closed data). Clue is used as a data feed only; everything downstream is original.

SECTION 4

Scope for This Sprint

The smallest useful version is real data flowing through to tailored notifications. Progress against the original must-haves:

Must-haves

- **Pull real cycle/symptom data — done.** An ingest script reads the newest Clue export, normalizes it and computes a prediction. Three period episodes, two complete cycles and the first symptom records are in the store.
- **Predictive heads-up notifications — mostly built.** The app is a home-screen PWA using Web Push on Vercel's free tier; a test notification reached the iPhone on the first attempt. The current prediction is a window (Nov 2–5, low confidence) rather than a single date. A daily scheduled job, a rules engine and server-side storage are written; the first real scheduled send is the remaining step.
- **Research-backed tips — built, not yet sent.** Implemented as a small curated library with a citation attached to every tip, rather than generated text, so no health claim is invented.

Out of scope (unchanged)

- Trend alerts — deferred on data volume, not on effort. Two cycles is not enough to support a claim, and one promising flow-intensity pattern was tested this sprint and failed.
- Export for medical appointments.
- A fully built-out companion app. A minimal PWA now exists as the notification surface.

SECTION 5

What Does Success Look Like?

Success means the integration pulls real data and sends at least one real predictive notification and one research-backed tip. Real data and real push delivery are both proven; what remains is the unattended daily job sending those two notifications on its own. Because cycles run monthly, predictive accuracy still cannot be validated inside the sprint window — that is assessed as data accumulates.

SECTION 6

Open Questions or Risks

Three questions from the original brief are now closed: the data source is Clue; symptoms do come through in its export; and push runs as a PWA with Web Push on Vercel. Still open:

- Verifying the scheduled job end to end — storage and cron are written but have not yet produced a real unattended notification.
- Ideal notification frequency, still undetermined; over-notifying would get the app muted.
- How to incorporate per-notification feedback (thumbs up/down) — the buttons exist, the learning loop does not.
- Data volume is the binding constraint on every insight feature: predictions stay low confidence and symptom trends stay out of reach until more cycles are logged.